

Journal Paper 1 Summary (25 points total)

Paper Title	Designing for the Distracted: A User-Centered Approach to Explore and Act on the User Experiences of People with Short Attention Spans
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1. What do you think the paper is about in layman's terms? What did the research focus on, what did the authors find and what are the main conclusions (if any) [5 points]

Focus of this question
• This question encourages you to evaluate the arguments, evidence, assumptions, and conclusions about key issues (i.e. think critically about the paper) • This question encourages you to develop your own knowledge, comprehension and conceptual understanding and to connect, synthesize, and/or transform your ideas into a new form (i.e. be a creative thinker and contribute your ideas and thoughts)

Write your answer below:

This paper aims to explore the frustrations that people with short attention spans have while interacting with websites on the Internet. It focuses on the user experience through the eyes of individuals who have limited attention spans. The research focused on these two things:

1. How and why do people with short attentions spans experience frustrations while using websites?
2. What are some ethical and design considerations that may be drawn from their experiences?

The study had several important conclusions. The study was able to conclude that there are several user interface design choices such as creating efficient, easy navigation, and limiting external distractions are integral for keeping attention on a page and making it easier for people with limited attention spans to interact with a website. Another important conclusion that this study makes is speaking to the people's frustrations when using a website that is distracting or otherwise not designed in a way that supports limited attentions. The participants noted feeling overwhelmed, tired, or apathetic towards

continuing to try. Finally, this study had participants input their own feedback into what future HCI designers can do to make their websites feel more friendly towards people with limited attention spans. Some concrete examples of note are implementing more progress bars, reminders to stay on track, and customization options to enhance user experience.

2. How would you extend the research paper – what new area(s) would you focus the paper on? [5 points]

Focus of this question

- This question encourages you to develop your own knowledge, comprehension and conceptual understanding and to connect, synthesize, and/or transform your ideas into a new form (i.e. be a creative thinker and contribute your ideas and thoughts)

Write your answer below:

As someone who was misdiagnosed with ADHD, but still has various attention-related issues, I can attest that there are other parts of the internet that frustrate me daily. I would also focus on how living with technology that is constantly fiending for the user's attention is itself distracting. I (used to) spend about 4.5 hours on my phone a day because of notifications, distracting apps (social media), and being surrounded by an Internet that is constantly trying to capitalize on my attention all the time. To extend this paper, I would add social media app design into the pre-study, as well as choose some social media apps the workshop activities. I want to focus on just social media apps, because for me those were the most distracting applications with constant notifications, instant gratification from short form content, and constant discourse between other users. With this included, I would also want to keep a metric on mental health and a mood-based outcome as well.

3. Discuss at least three real-world applications (not mentioned in the paper) that would benefit from the focus of / applications of ideas mentioned in the paper and why?[15 points]

Focus of this question
• This question encourages you to connect your learning to “real world” issues or life experiences and consider diverse perspectives for the application of concepts in the paper to the real world • This question encourages you to reflect on what you are learning • This question encourages you to contribute your ideas and thoughts • Consider diverse perspectives (gender, political, ethnic, racial, etc) during class or in assignments • Challenges you to develop and present your own knowledge, comprehension, and conceptual understanding

Write your answer below:

I think that an application that would benefit from these ideas mentioned in the paper would be any type of travel booking website. I am intentionally stealing this idea because it was mentioned in the study and I realize how *infuriating* it is sometimes to book/plan a vacation. A more personal example is when I was booking my trip to China this April and I was using Expedia for the first time to try and book flights that I could coordinate with friends that were also going. The experience was abysmal because of all the distracting advertisements and unclear instructions on where to go next. I eventually got it booked but it did take me 45 minutes to do so.

Another application that would benefit from these ideas are any type of productivity app such as Google calendar, Notion, Obsidian, etc. These productivity apps are very useful in many ways, but they have SO MUCH FUNCTIONALITY sometimes it overwhelms me into a decision paradox. A lot of productivity apps such as Notion or Obsidian pride themselves in being a catch all for all your productivity needs, and while that is nice, it can be very overwhelming for someone with a limited attention span who just wants to take some notes.

Finally, social media apps. In the beginning, these apps were designed to connect with friends, family, and share interesting moments with this group of people. Now, it is full of short-form video content, fan-bases, and less about connecting with others and more about flexing your highlights to all your friends to basically say “look at all the cool shit I’m doing and you’re not”. As someone who was (unfortunately) on social media at too young of an age (13 years old) it definitely has stunted my attention span, and led me down a road of mental health concerns, going back to the roots of why social media

was created in the first place would be a great thing to see and experience in an Internet full of highlights.